



A TARUN TAHILIANI & ADITYA BIRLA GROUP VENTURE

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Indian Menswear



COMPANY

TASVA

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**6MK013 – CONSUMER
BEHAVIOUR AND THE
RESPONSIBLE
MARKETER**

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Declaration Form

I hereby declare that: -

- The submission is my own work
- All materials used has been acknowledged and
- appropriately referenced
- I have not allowed other student to access to your work
- The work has not been submitted previously.

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Introduction

Tasva is owned by Indivinity Clothing, the result of a 2021 collaboration between Tarun Tahiliani and Aditya Birla Fashion & Retail Ltd. Tasva was established in December 2021 and dominantly serves the high-end occasion-wear market while providing menswear at flexible price points (Livemint, 2022). Men's kurtas, achkans, bandhgalas, jodhpuris, and sherwanis are sold by Tasva. The company debuted its fourth location in Bengaluru (Livemint, 2022). Tasva plans to open 75 stores across India by March 2023 to expand their retail footprint throughout country to make their brand accessible (Livemint, 2022). The brand aspires to a permanent transformation of Indian festivities. The brand focuses on comfort for men and is designed to wear the cultural heritage as a comfort and not a cultural baggage (Tasva, 2021).

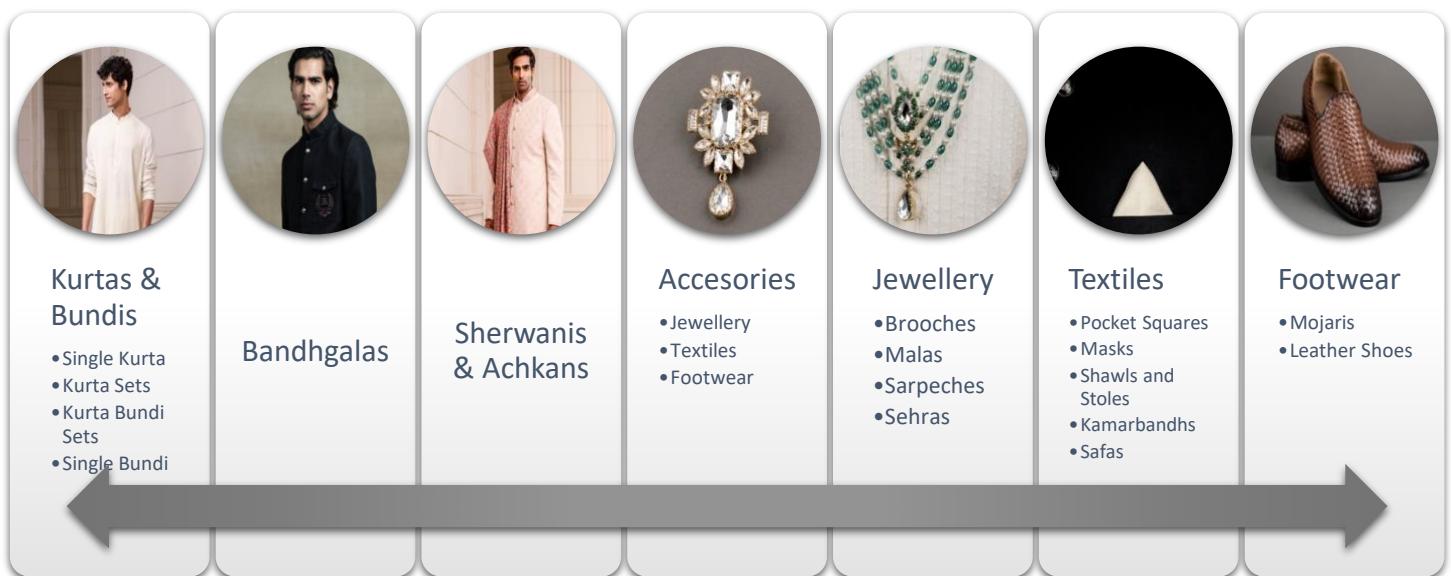


Fig.1.1 – Product Portfolio of Tasva (Tasva, 2021).

The suggested product line for Tasva is a South Indian bridal wear segment under the name of 'Aurum'. Aurum is gold in Latin and South Indian bridal wear have a lot of gold embroidery involved in their authentic wedding wear.

Segmentation approach

Target audience is the particular demographic of customers most likely to be interested in your product or service and, as a result, the group that should see your advertising efforts. Age, gender, wealth, location, interests, and a variety of other criteria may all have an impact on who your target audience is (Marketing Evolution, 2021).

Tasva's product line is entirely based on male apparel for Indian ethnic wear, however. For them to successfully launch a whole new product line, they need to target something which maximises their profit and also solves the demand of potential customers as there are more than 10 million weddings happening in India in a year and other large scale festivities (Menon, 2014). The Ethnic Wear industry in India is worth \$70 Billion and almost 85% of it is women's ethnic wear and is expected to grow at a compound annual growth rate of 10% in the span of 3 years until 2022 (Menon, 2014). The south Indian silk sarees (kancheepuram) are a geographical indication for Tamil Nadu and these sarees are worn for weddings and other special occasions (Kancheepuram District, 2022). With a contribution of almost 18% to the global silk production, India ranks as the second-largest producer in the world. In South India, Kanchipuram is a notable silk producer (Kancheepuram District, 2022). A small group of merchants who used to buy and sell sarees from the area's weavers initially controlled this sector of the economy. One of the largest societies today, the Kamatchi Amman Society has over 2000 members. There are roughly 50,000 weavers who are employed by various co-operative societies overall. In Kanchipuram, there are about 60,000 silk looms at work. The town's annual revenue surpasses Rs. 200 crores, while its exports are about Rs. 3 crores (Kancheepuram District, 2022). This segment and industry is in demand as south Indian silk is considered to be very authentic and many south Indians have a lot of weddings and festivities even. Tasva would be able to increase their reach and potential consumers by a long reach by entering the south Indian silk industry and the women ethnic wear industry at the same time.

(358 Words)



Fig.1.2 – authentic Kancheepuram Saree (Anya, 2022)

Kotler's Table of Segmentation

<u>Segmentation variable</u>	<u>Segment</u>
Geographic Region, area, Temperature climate, population density	<u>Region</u> : India <u>Area</u> : Urban city <u>Climate</u> : Tropical <u>Average Temperature</u> : 24.46°C <u>Population density</u> : 464 per sq. km
Demographic Age, gender, education, work-status, socio-economic, SEC classification, family structure, religion, nationality.	<u>Age</u> : 21 to 42 <u>Gender</u> : Female <u>Family size</u> : Joint family, Nuclear Family <u>Education</u> : Graduate, Post Graduate <u>Work status</u> : Home-Maker, Part-time employed, Full-time employed <u>Socio-economic</u> : Upper Middle class, Upper class <u>Religion</u> : Hindu <u>Nationality</u> : Indian
Behavioural Attitude, loyalty, perceived benefits, users status, purchase and consumption pattern	<u>Attitude</u> : Good quality, Positive, Comfortable <u>Loyalty</u> : Experiments, Soft core loyal <u>Perceived benefits</u> : Quality, Value for money, Enhancements <u>User status</u> : First time users, Potential users <u>Purchase and consumption pattern</u> : Low

Psychographic lifestyle, AIO, interests, personality, VALS	<u>Lifestyle</u> : Fashionable, Comfortable, Designer clothes <u>Personality</u> : Online Shopping, Traditional, Rich culture, Ethnicity <u>Activity</u> : Work, Education <u>Interests</u> : Social Gathering, Wedding, Family <u>Opinions</u> : Social media, Social issues <u>VALS</u> : Thinkers, Experiencers
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The targeted audience is around the age of 21 to 42 since the legal marriage age in India starts at 21 (Jaswal, 2022). The average age of a bride to be is at 22.1 in India and these age group represents Thinkers and Experiencers (Strategic Business Insights, 2020). They are following the latest fashion trends and are ready to experience something new and are responsive to online shopping as well (Strategic Business Insights, 2020). This niche sits perfectly for online shopping and store owner brand like Tasva. Consequently, they represent a devoted group of upper middle class and upper middle class buyers who are well-educated, and about to be wed couples (statsita, 2022).

(113 Words)

DAMP Model

Distinctive: top designers like Tarun Tahiliani, Manish Malhotra and many more haven't touched the south Indian silk sarees niche as of yet. This information will be easily found on their websites as they have no product line based on south Indian silk sarees. Tasva can enter a niche but a very successful market by making high end designer silk sarees with traditional and Indo-western options for our experimenters and Thinkers. Tasva should implement a **Horizontal Product Differentiation** strategy in order to stand out the most with their designer product compared to its competitors (Kopp, 2021). Using Multichannel marketing will attract potential consumers to offline stores and create more traffic on the official website which will lead to more engagement.

Accessible: Tasva has a good online presence with consistent social media marketing done by using sponsored posts on Instagram and ads starring Bollywood stars like Ranbir Kapoor and Ananya Pandey (BrandWagon, 2022). They have a wide social media presence and they also have their own 4 opened store outlets and they plan to have around 75 stores by March 2023 (Livemint, 2022). Their

website is very user friendly for online shopping experience which helps the experiencers and Thinkers to make based on their VALS personality (Strategic Business Insights, 2020). All of their products feature excellent product information, which only improves the customer's buying experience. With Ananya Pandey being their brand ambassador, it will broaden the reach of the Aurum segment towards Tasva's potential consumers.

Measurable: by using geographic location, mobile targeting, tracking online navigation and their purchase behaviour, a series of personalised messages, prompt offers and promotional messages can be sent to potential consumers at the right time if they track this data. This is called behavioural targeting and it helps to send messages to potential customers at the right time and more accurately (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019). **Predictive Analytics** can be used to foresee and measure the consumers future purchases based on the webpage they clicked or visited and by past purchases data. Online navigation will help Tasva to sponsor ads onto various social media sights and other online marketing to such consumers who are displaying high level of product involvement and purchase intentions (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019).

Profitable: this segment is fairly profitable as shown above the market for silk sarees is huge and Tasva is already in the wedding industry and if a well-established designer brand makes silk sarees for our potential south Indian customers the profitability will increase as the demand is too high and the existing competitors don't have a high level of social media presence like Tasva's. Tasva is already targeting consumer whose sinus typology factors direct towards middle class, upper middle class, and upper class so even if people earn less than \$10,000 (middle class) which is over more than 8 lakhs per month and they can afford to buy bridal wear ranging 30,000 INR to 3,00,000 INR depending on their socio-economic class (statsita, 2022). The brand Prescence and value and its already successful campaigns will lead the consumers to trust this niche product segment and the untouched designer silk saree industry.

(500 Words)

Customer Journey and Decision making process

Marketing teams frequently utilise the decision journey to provide helpful touchpoints at each level of the choice process. The decision journey identifies the important stages a consumer takes to attain their goal (Magic, 2021).

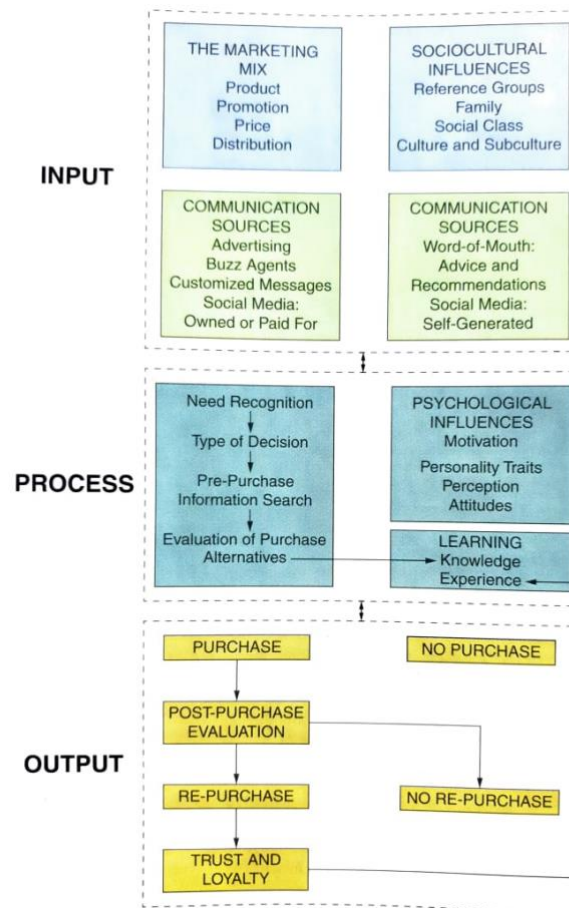


Fig.1.3 – Consumer decision-making model (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019).

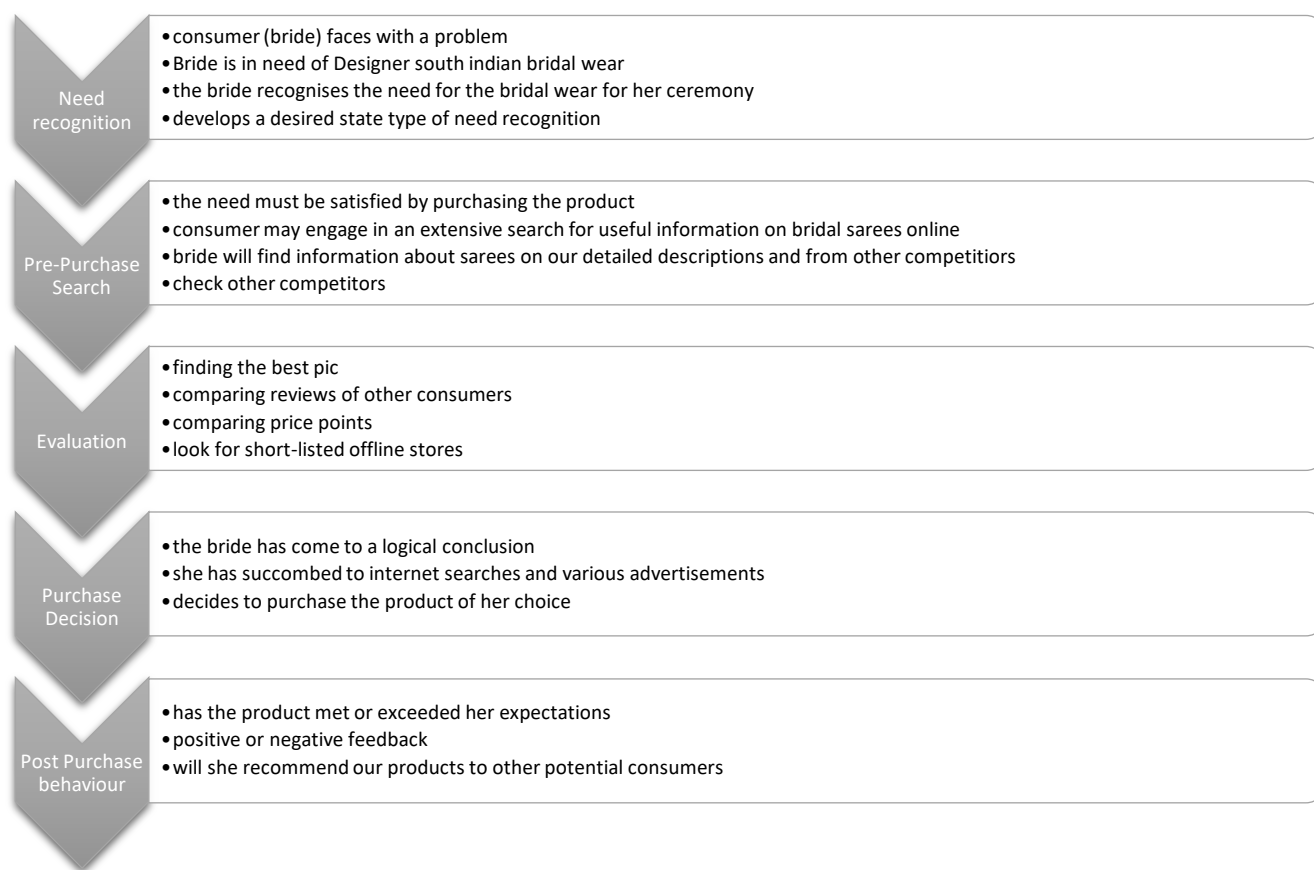


Fig.1.4 – consumer decision process of Kancheepuram sarees (Professional Academy, 2022) (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019).

Marketing and promotional strategies can be used to influence the segment even more by focusing on social media marketing which can attract consumers more natural based on their google searches. Sponsored posts on Instagram target consumers who are finding similar products based on their past searches from google and other apps which can help them reach their target audience (Reynolds, 2012). Email marketing is another strategy which can be used on a weekly basis during wedding seasons and by offering various prompt offers and discounts on delivery charges or giving away free delivery which will help our consumers to reach out to our websites more often (Reynolds, 2012). The last promotional strategy would be to use current brand ambassadors or hire new brand ambassadors to make new TV advertisements which can be used on YouTube ads and can be posted under the celebrity/ambassadors social media accounts to reach a huge number of engaging audience. (188 Words)

Key influences

Consumers are influenced by a number of significant factors when deciding whether to buy a bridal silk saree. Customers' buying habits are influenced by a number of factors, including individual, cultural, and social factors.

Diffusion of Innovation Theory

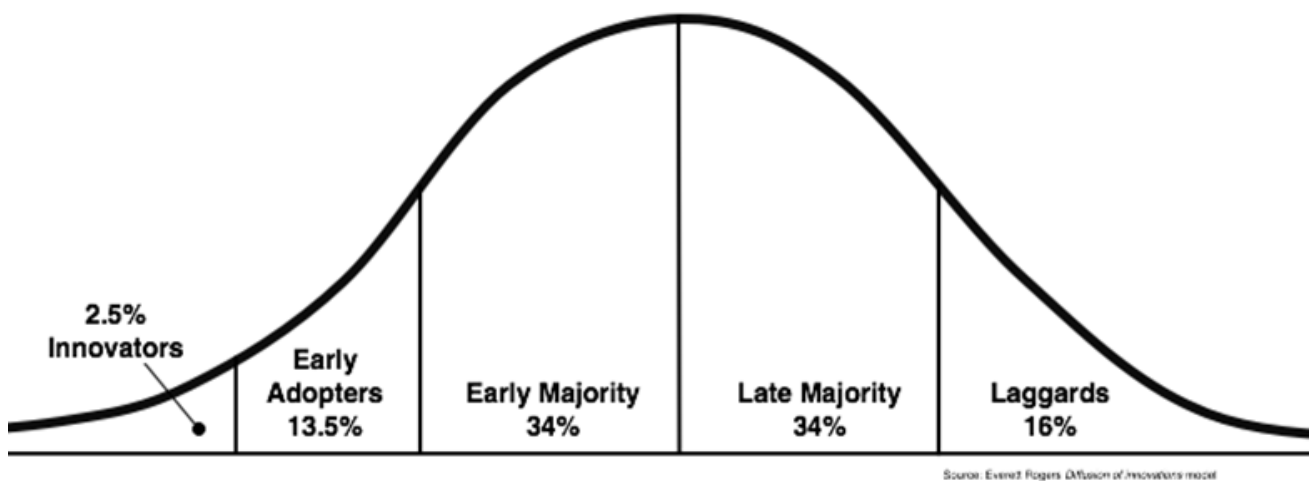


Fig.1.5 – Five main factors that influence adoption of an innovation (LaMorte, 2019).

The diffusion of innovations theory is a notion detailing how newer technological and other developments spread throughout societies and cultures, from introduction to broad adoption. The diffusion of innovations hypothesis aims to explain how and why new concepts and methods spread over potentially lengthy durations to understand the characteristics of the target population (Halton, 2021).

- *Innovators* – Those who are willing to take chances and are the first to try new things (Halton, 2021). There is a Relative Advantage for **Aurum** as it's a modified version of a similar product in existence a.k.a a dynamically continuous innovation (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019). This category of our target audience get influenced easily by their drive to try the innovation and they can be attracted by offering customisation on Aurum and product testing for our initial orders to build up trust, word of mouth and clientele.

- *Early Adopters* – They stand in for influential persons. They like taking on leadership responsibilities and embracing change. They readily accept new ideas since they are already conscious of the need for change (LaMorte, 2019). Targeting Social Media influencers and sponsoring their wedding sarees will provide potential consumers to engage in our product line and Tasva's brand name will become more credible.
- *Early Majority* – People who are both members of the general public and who open the door for the adoption of an innovation in mainstream society (LaMorte, 2019). The Complexity of **Aurum** may inject a fear of social rejection as the innovation may not be perceived as a social norm and to counter that Tasva should take official pictures of their clients using the Aurum product line to mainstream it (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019).
- *Late Majority* – Since they are resistant to change, they won't adopt a new idea until the majority of people have given it a shot (LaMorte, 2019). In this category, the target audience is more open to trialability on a limited basis while depending on the wide scale and usage of the line and evidence of it. Tasva can provide pictures of the bride who have purchased before to provide authenticity in their marketing strategies.
- *Laggards* – People who lag behind the general population in accepting innovative items and fresh ideas. This is primarily because they are risk-averse and fixed in their ways (Halton, 2021). These people are deeply rooted in tradition and are staunchly conservative (LaMorte, 2019). Traditional south Indian consumers may take the longest time to buy designer sarees from a new brand as they have old traditional saree sellers who have been in business since decades. This causes them to stick to their fixed ways.

Innovators	Early Adopters	Early Majority	Late Majority	Laggards
• Custom based orders for initial consumers • Target upper class clientele who are willing to explore.	• Target social Media Influencers who are either on the verge to get married or are shooting an advertisement for the segment. • provide additional accessories such as broches and pins to this category of customers as freebies.	• Take pictures of brides who have used sarees from the Aurum collection. • use these pictures to create a new norm in order to mainstream the product so newer audience try the product.	• Provide evidence of Aurum being used in weddings through marketing sucess stories and evidence of aurum's success. • Advertise customer feedbacks along Aurum's marketing strategy to implement an evidence of Aurum's sucess.	• Fear appeals and pressure from other people will lead to laggards adopting to this innovation [Aurum] (LaMorte, 2019).

Fig.1.6 – Recommendations for each category of The Diffusion of Innovation Model.

The Culture Production Process

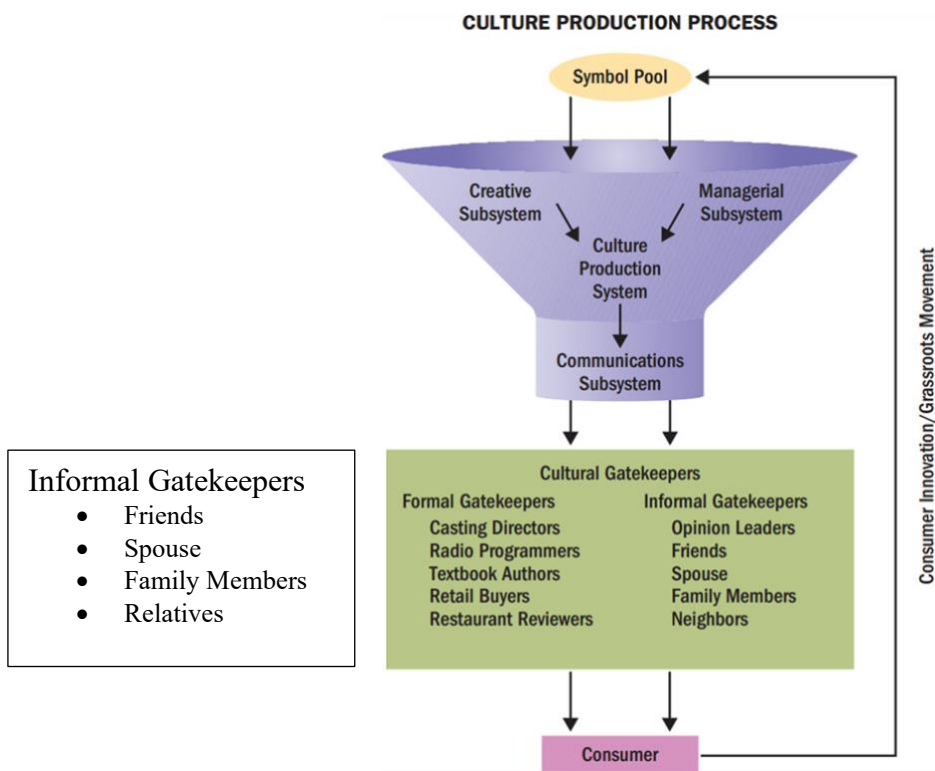


Fig.1.7 – CPS Diagram (Canvas,2022) (Solomon, 2020, p.534).

It's intriguing for a number of reasons to think of culture as a learned set of attitudes and behaviours.

First, it highlights the ways groups can come into conflict with one another. People simply pick up

diverse behaviours from other members of their culture (Niosi, 2021). A CPS is "the set of individuals and organisations that create and market a cultural product" (Solomon, 2020, p.534) (Canvas,2022). The three subsystems for Tasva would be as following:

- A creative subsystem: The **Aurum** segment is the creative subsystem designed for the cultural product as a new symbol to the existing cultural products available (Canvas,2022). To make Aurum as a new symbol for kancheepuram sarees Tasva can offer free trials of testing the product line by letting potential consumers wear it and test it.
- A managerial subsystem: the whole selection, production and the supervision and management of the entire segment from Tasva will be the managerial subsystem (Canvas,2022). Tasva can use batch production to manufacture the segment as every garment will have different designs and sizes. Tasva's garment designing will provide top quality for their product and help brides with better maneuver and comfort (Textilemegastore.com, 2021). The creation process of the silk saree will impact consumers to opt for a sustainable and designer piece of garment. For the offline experience, Tasva's retail stores will have employees trained to become experts in this segment to solve all queries of our customers during expert consultation. The store ambience will also need to be adjusted to focus more on brides to make them feel comfortable, special and prioritised while displaying in house made designs of bridal sarees. For the online experience, the website shall have detailed product description and offer customisation on gold patterns on their sarees along with colour options. For online purchases a convenient delivery tie shall be set or asked by coordinating with our consumers.
- A communications subsystem: an advertising team who would handle the marketing promotions and marketing tactics to deliver our prompts and messages to our target audience (Canvas,2022). Advertising Aurum while expressing the emotion of traditions while displaying modernism fits best to Tasva's target audience.

Our cultural gatekeepers as mentioned above next to Fig.1.7 would influence and filter the product choices for our target audience. These cultural gatekeepers are Pop Mavericks and **Networked intelligentsia** who prefer brands where they can personalise brands and have a preference over cult brands (Shiffman and Wisenblit 2019, p.304) (Canvas, 2022). They learn about these cultures through **Formal learning** from their parents or other members from their community and family through **Enculturation** (Canvas, 2022).

Marriage culture in India as a subculture

Regardless of caste, culture, or creed, weddings occupy a particular place in the hearts of every Indian family. These are financed appropriately since they are the culmination of a lifetime. In fact, many families set aside their whole life savings for this one occasion, which is frequently bolstered with loans and borrowings from friends and relatives. Even more is thought to be saved for this occasion, up to one-fifth of the typical person's lifetime income (www.fibre2fashion.com, 2020). However since the average marriage age in India is 22.1, it is safe to assume that the current target audience is a mix of Gen Z and millennials or we can coin it as GenZennials is more laser focused on the financial consequences of their decisions (Goldman Sachs, 2016) as a consumer.

The Sociological Model of Consumer Behaviour

According to the sociological model of consumer behaviour, a person's position within various societal groups, including their family, friends, and workgroups, might affect their purchasing decisions. In essence, a person will make purchases depending on what is appropriate or customary for the group they belong to (Needle, 2021).



Fig.1.8 – Definition of sociological model of consumer behaviour (Needle, 2021).

The model holds that a consumer is a member of society and may belong to several social groups. These groups have an impact on her purchasing decisions. It might surprise you to learn that there have always been several social classes, castes, and factions within the human race. Depending on these various types of partnerships, her responses alter correspondingly (Neostrom, 2021b). Tasva's target audience operates on **Expert power** where they are influenced to purchase the silk sarees by either consulting in offline stores or through the **primary group's** experiences in purchasing silk sarees for their or someone else's wedding (Canvas, 2022) which tends to influence on the consumer behaviour.

Impact on future marketing plans or strategies

Tasva's upcoming marketing strategies may be impacted by all the major factors influencing consumer behaviour because that behaviour tends to change over time. However, staying in contact with your target audience and gathering data about it can assist you to concentrate on our customers

and keep the business venture passionate (Olenski, 2017). This is only feasible if you have a good awareness of your target audience's demographic. As a result, Tasva will be able to convince potential customers of the value of their goods (Olenski, 2017).

(1263 Words)

Ethical and responsible marketing

Product safety, truthfulness in marketing communications, integrity in dealings with customers and distributors, pricing issues, and the effects of marketing decisions on the environment and society are just a few examples of the issues covered by marketing ethics, which are moral principles and values that serve as a guide for behaviour in the field of marketing (Jobber, 2007, in Vincent, 2009, p.184) (Canvas, 2022). Consumers desire an ethically made product for their as it shows the organisation is trying to be socially responsible.

The silk weaving in`dustry has been severely affected by the pandemic and are still struggling to make ends meet (Nath, 2021), earlier every silk saree weaver would be paid after finishing one saree but after covid the labourers are struggling and aren't able to get paid because the system of their wages has been disturbed (Nath, 2021). Ensuring wages to be paid on time will help our silk weavers to be motivated for more work and they will be able to deliver us a more effective and quality work. One of the other ethical problems of the silk saree industry is that many moths are killed in order to make silk sarees but the solution to cruelty silk saree has already been found (Gogoi, 2020). For every pound of silk that is produced, over 3000 silkworms are sacrificed. That indicates that this results in the yearly killing of billions of silkworms (Gogoi, 2020). Instead of using silkworms, letting them completely live their cycles and using their cocoons to spun yarn which is weaved into silk sarees is a more cruelty free approach and it helps to promote ethical practices to make silk sarees (Gogoi, 2020). However there are some challenges to it which needs a capital for a spinning mill and support large scale production help to make it a more sustainable approach, there also fakes available in the market and verifying our suppliers by checking their certification and method of

weaving silk will help us to be more ethical towards our consumers and Tasva's recognition for ethical practices will increase even more (Gogoi, 2020).

Since many silk weavers are finding it difficult to strive in the silk saree industry, this is leading to a decline in silk weavers and by helping them by promoting this social cause and giving 5 percent of the earnings to the weavers will lead to a social responsibility and help many silk weavers. By initiating this movement Tasva will have a greater chance to become a more ethical brand which helps their staff and suppliers for a greater cause which makes the brand more transparent towards their audience and promotes an aid towards their own brand. By giving them a part of the profits will lead the weavers to recruit more silk weavers/ labourers and strengthen their silk yarn factories with efficient staff. The promotion of this social cause will improve brand image and helps to form an alternative solution to government legislation (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019). This will also lead to people favouring our products and also eliminate business of our competitors who violate this issue (Schiffman, Wisenblit and S Ramesh Kumar, 2019).

(526 Words)

Conclusion

To conclude, the Kancheepuram Sarees are a niche market with very high demand. The designer sarees in an Indo-western style is an innovation which will have a foundation of sustainability, ethics and latest fashion which helps to raise awareness for a social cause while earning profits for the company. I believe, this segmentation approach has a huge scope for profits as we haven't touched the female bridal/ethnic garment industry which holds a majority of the percentage in the Indian ethnic industry by 85%. By focusing on the recommendations while developing a market strategy will keep the company prepared for the usual consumer behaviour and how to tackle those problems to attract more consumers.

(113 Words)

Appendix 1

Engel-Kollat-Blackwell (EKB) Model of Consumer Behaviour

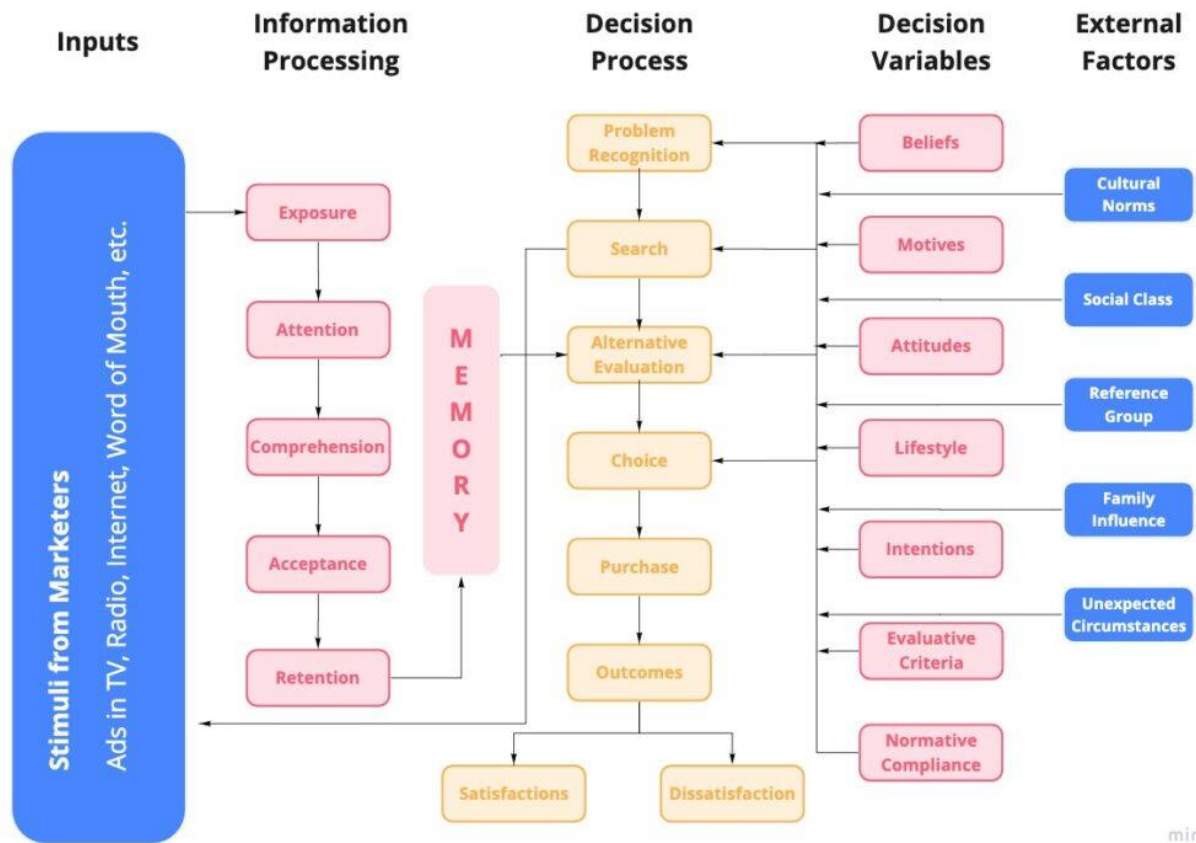


Fig.1.A – EKB Model of Consumer Behaviour (Neostrom, 2021)

This business model can be used by companies who face numerous rivals offering comparable goods or services. The objective is to outperform your competitors in a highly competitive product market by catering to customers at every point of their journey (Needle, 2021).

Information input: in this stage the consumer is exposed to all kinds of stimuli which they get from marketing and non-marketing sources which enhances the influence over their problem recognition factor (Francis, 2014) (Neostrom, 2021). In Tasva's scenario their potential consumers can either be influenced their marketing/promotional tactics (e.g. TV advertisements) and our competitors promotional tactics or can be influenced by themselves by word of mouth or circumstances which

leads to them to recognise their problem which is the need to purchase a bridal silk saree for their wedding.

Information Processing: Exposure, attention, comprehension, and memory of marketing- and non-marketing-related stimuli comprise information processing, as seen in the diagram. The consumer must be exposed to the message appropriately and repeatedly for there to be significant sales (Jobs, 2009). Conscientious cognitive style makes the consumer wonder more about the brand and the product and try to find information regarding the product. The cognitive style of Visual Construct, where the consumer will prefer to look at the Aurum Collection visually in our offline stores and check the authenticity to their satisfaction can lead them to a decision. Logic is another method of process information where they will gather facts to justify their thinking by comparing price points with our competitors, comparing quality their budget and etc. (Neostrom, 2021).

Decision Process: in this stage the model's five fundamental decision-process stages are its primary focus. The decision making process is explained in Fig.1.4.

Decision Variables: this stage consists of all the factors which will affect their decision and it includes environmental and external factors (Jobs, 2009). Our consumers may be affected by many factors like cultural norms and south Indian weddings have a lot of cultural value to it (Das, 2020) and also financial factors and their budget for the product.

Appendix 2

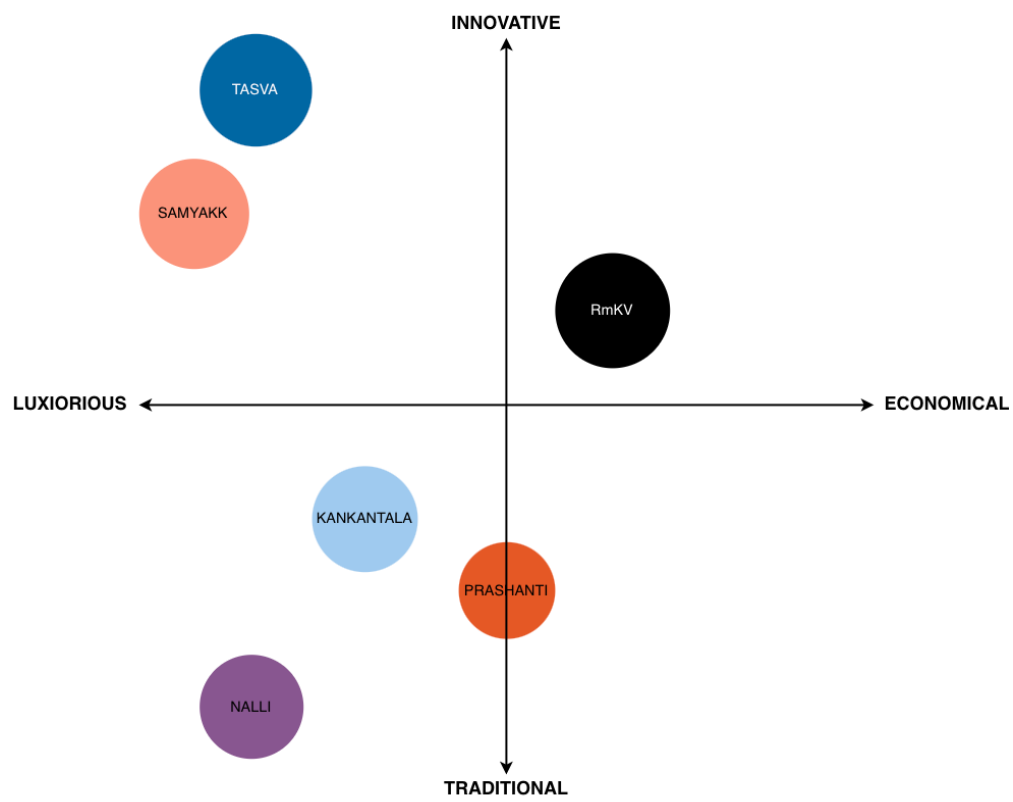


Fig.1.B – Perceptual map

Appendix 3